

Top 10 games this week · for the playoff field

Week 1 · 2026 season · data Sep 3 · SP+ 2026
0 locks · 1 likely · 11 on the bubble

THE FIELD RIGHT NOW

0 locks (90%+), 1 likely (75–90%), 11 on the bubble (25–75%). Projected field: Ohio St, Oregon, Notre Dame, Georgia, Indiana, Texas Tech, Texas, LSU, Texas A&M, Miami, BYU, Boise St.

Ranked by leverage · how often the result changes who makes the 12-team field, discounted by how unlikely the swing is

1	Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN	Leverage 66	Impact 59
#19 SMU (52%) at Florida State (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5			
Changes who makes the field in 19.7% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: SMU (62%), Florida State (28%), Miami (12%).			
2	Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · ABC	Leverage 49	Impact 55
Clemson (28%) at #11 LSU (72%) LSU -10 · O/U 50.5			
Changes who makes the field in 18.3% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: LSU (57%), Clemson (38%), Texas A&M (4%).			
3	Sun, Sep 6 · 1930 ET · ABC	Leverage 41	Impact 40
#24 Louisville (37%) at #9 Ole Miss (63%) Ole Miss -6.5 · O/U 55.5			
Changes who makes the field in 13.2% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Ole Miss (53%), Louisville (38%), Georgia (5%).			
4	Sat, Sep 5 · 2200 ET · CW	Leverage 31	Impact 29
UNLV (60%) at Hawai'i (40%) UNLV -3 · O/U 55.5			
Changes who makes the field in 9.5% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: UNLV (62%), Hawai'i (19%), North Dakota State (9%).			
5	Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · ESPN	Leverage 27	Impact 73
#7 Miami (91%) at Stanford (9%) Miami -24.5 · O/U 48.5			
Changes who makes the field in 24.5% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Miami (74%), SMU (11%), Louisville (10%).			
6	Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ESPNU	Leverage 26	Impact 26
Liberty (34%) at James Madison (66%) James Madison -6 · O/U 50.5			
Changes who makes the field in 8.8% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: James Madison (57%), Liberty (44%), Boise State (7%).			
7	Sun, Sep 6 · 1930 ET · NBC	Leverage 17	Impact 50
Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5 · O/U 46.5			
Changes who makes the field in 16.5% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Notre Dame (81%), Wisconsin (10%), BYU (4%).			
8	Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ABC	Leverage 17	Impact 18
Baylor (32%) at Auburn (68%) Auburn -7.5 · O/U 59.5			
Changes who makes the field in 5.9% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Auburn (58%), Baylor (23%), Georgia (6%).			
9	Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX	Leverage 15	Impact 39
Fresno State (10%) at #14 USC (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5			
Changes who makes the field in 13.0% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: USC (69%), Fresno State (22%), Penn State (5%).			
10	Sat, Sep 5 · 1230 ET · CW	Leverage 14	Impact 18
Miami (OH) (23%) at Pittsburgh (77%) Pittsburgh -16.5 · O/U 47.5			
Changes who makes the field in 6.1% of simulated seasons			
Teams most often swapped in or out: Miami (OH) (58%), Pittsburgh (34%), UNLV (4%).			

Leverage and impact are scaled 0–100 against the biggest remaining game. Win chances from SP+ with home advantage; every number from 30,000 simulated seasons with each game flipped one at a time.